

I Say / You Say / They Say

What Is This?

I Say / You Say / They Say is a discussion and writing routine that helps you learn how to explain ideas, use evidence, and respond to others respectfully.

Step 1: I Say (Teacher Models)

What happens: - The teacher shows how to respond to a text, image, or question. - The teacher explains their thinking out loud.

Example:

I say the author believes earthquakes happen at plate boundaries because the text explains plates move and collide.

Step 2: You Say (Guided Practice)

What happens: - You practice with support from the teacher and classmates. - Sentence starters help you explain your thinking.

Sentence Starters: - *You say that...* - *One idea from the text/image is...* - *The evidence shows...*

Example:

You say the image shows continents fitting together because their coastlines match.

Step 3: They Say (Independent Thinking)

What happens: - You respond to a peer's idea or the text on your own. - You may agree, disagree, or add a new idea.

Sentence Starters: - *They say..., and I agree/disagree because...* - *Building on what they said...* - *Another way to think about this is...*

Example:

They say the continents moved slowly over time, and I agree because GPS data shows plate movement today.

Why This Helps

- Gives you a clear structure for discussion and writing
- Helps you use evidence from texts and visuals
- Builds confidence sharing ideas

Where We Use It

- Reading and writing
- Science explanations
- Social studies discussions
- Interpreting images, graphs, and data

Remember: Everyone starts with support. Over time, you'll do more thinking on your own!